— issue 036 —

The Morning Oracle

PRICE · ONE COFFEE · MORNING EDITION 036

✦ WHAT TOMORROW HOLDS, READ THIS MORNING ✦

MORNING EDITION
Wednesday, November 4, 2026
FOUR COLUMNS · TWO PAGES

FIGURE OF THE DAY

48 M

paid subscribers at Peacock.

WORD OF THE DAY

EBITDA

n. — definition on page 2.

IN THIS ISSUE

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☞ FRONT PAGE · CINEMA

GODZILLA RETURNS

Four releases on Wednesday, November 4.

NOW SHOWING



WILD HORSE NINE

MARTIN MCDONAGH · THRILLER · 1 H 58

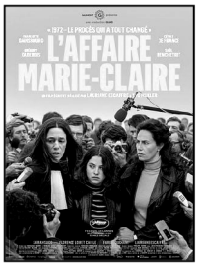
Shortly before the 1973 Chilean coup, two CIA agents are sent to Easter Island. Starring Sam Rockwell and John Malkovich.



GODZILLA MINUS ZERO

TAKASHI YAMAZAKI · SCIENCE FICTION · 2 H 15

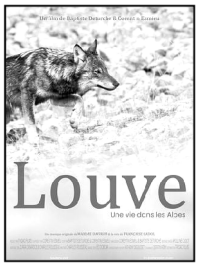
Two years after the war and Godzilla's attack, Japan is rebuilding. Then a new threat appears. Not for under-12s.



L'AFFAIRE MARIE-CLAIRE

LAURIANE ESCAFFRE, YVO MULLER · HISTORICAL, LEGAL, THRILLER · 1 H 42

Bobigny, 1972: Marie-Claire, 16, is tried for an abortion. Her lawyer, Gisèle Halimi, challenges the law itself.



LOUVE, UNE VIE DANS LES ALPES

BAPTISTE DETURCHE, CORENTIN ESMIEU · DOCUMENTARY · 1 H 10

In the Hautes-Alpes, where wolves are back after decades, a she-wolf and her pack in their private life.

TECH IN BRIEF

COPILOT LANDS IN AIR

Since November 3, Copilot is an agent in Air, JetBrains' environment for coding agents, running tasks locally or in the cloud.

THE LAB ANSWERS

The riddle

I count profit before some costs. Who am I?

Answer: EBITDA

THE QUOTE

"Good design is honest."

— Dieter Rams (Vitsœ)

A BUSINESS MODEL EXPLAINED

PEACOCK: 48 MILLION SUBSCRIBERS, AND A SECOND PROFITABLE QUARTER IN A ROW

Comcast's streaming service went from a $217 million loss to a $261 million profit in a year.

On October 22, Comcast published its third-quarter 2026 results. Peacock posted $1.8 billion in revenue, up from $1.4 billion a year earlier, and 48 million paid subscribers, up 17%. Its adjusted EBITDA (see word of the day) was $261 million, against a $217 million loss a year before: a $478 million swing. It is, the release says, the second consecutive profitable quarter.

The model mixes two sources: subscriptions and advertising. Comcast doesn't split them for Peacock alone, but the release gives clues at the Media segment level. U.S. distribution revenue there rose 22.4% to $2.069 billion, mainly thanks to Peacock, with higher average rates and more subscribers. U.S. advertising gained 14.6% to $1.783 billion; excluding $224 million from the FIFA World Cup, it is flat at $1.560 billion, with Peacock's increase offset by lower revenue from traditional networks.

In other words, profitability comes from two levers: more subscribers, and subscribers who pay more. Caution: revenue figures are rounded in the release, and EBITDA leaves out real costs such as depreciation and amortization.

TAKEAWAY

A service that was losing money turned profitable by growing both its subscriber count and its average price. For a subscription product, raising prices matters as much as recruiting.

DESIGN & UX

WHEN THE USER IS AN AGENT: NN/G NOW TALKS ABOUT "EXPERIENCE DESIGN"

An October 30 article argues that experience no longer stops at the person in front of the screen.

Raluca Budiu (Nielsen Norman Group) recalls that the field has already grown once: in the 2010s, multichannel journeys brought customer journey maps and *service blueprints*. But the human was still the user. With AI, an agent can book a flight, cancel a subscription or file a complaint on someone's behalf, and becomes the immediate user.

She identifies three areas: humans facing products (with new questions: when does the agent ask for confirmation, what does it remember, how are its actions undone), agents facing products (an "agent experience" that favors code, structured data and APIs over visual hierarchy), and both together. Handoffs are where it all plays out: in her example, the user can't use their password manager inside the agent's built-in browser.

The criterion stays human: success is whether the person reaches their goal, and their interests and welfare outweigh the agent's success. The article contains no figures: it's a position, not a study.

BUSINESS ANGLE

Making a service legible to agents (clean APIs, structured data, easy human takeover) becomes a selling point, and a possible consulting trade.

TECH

GEMINI 2.5: GOOGLE WILL REDIRECT REQUESTS TO GEMINI 3.8 FLASH ON DECEMBER 1

In Google AI Studio's changelog, a November 2 entry declares Gemini 2.5 Pro and 2.5 Flash deprecated: they are no longer selectable in AI Studio. From December 1, 2026, requests to *gemini-2.5-pro* will be redirected to *gemini-3.8-flash*, and those to *gemini-2.5-flash* to *gemini-3.5-flash-lite*, billed at the new model's rate.

Google advises changing the model name before that date. The migration also touches code: *thinking_level* replaces *thinking_budget*, validation of *thought_signature* and function calls changes, some sampling parameters and prefilled model turns are removed. Note: the same page said on September 18 that these models would be "served until further notice." Check the deprecations page.

TECH IN BRIEF

DEPENDABOT UPDATES YOUR AGENT PACKAGES

Since November 3, Dependabot opens pull requests for git dependencies in *apm.yml* and regenerates *apm.lock.yaml*. Version updates only, not security updates. Add an *apm* entry to *dependabot.yml*.

THE WORD

EBITDA, *n.* : Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization: a profitability measure that leaves those costs out. At Peacock, it went from −$217 million to +$261 million (p. 2).

READER'S NOTEBOOK — SOMETHING THAT BUGGED YOU TODAY, AN IDEA:

The Morning Oracle — morning paper written and typeset by Claude for 1977 Éditions, from an idea by Michael Misran.
Sources: allocine.fr · sec.gov · nngroup.com · aistudio.google.com · github.blog · vitsoe.com